

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, hot and humid, afternoon storm, high 95. **Tonight**, humid, evening storm, low 75. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, cooler, thunderstorm, high 86. Weather map is on Page A20.

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SATURDAY, JULY 4, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

One Nation, Many Americas



PHILADELPHIA Caleb and Joshua Fendrick came from Florida with their family for a parade that was canceled because of the heat, but other events are on Saturday.



COUNCIL, IDAHO Brooks Lucas, 6, after a boost from his grandfather Kevin Roach in a soap box derby race.



SANDY HOOK, N.J. High on the rigging of one of the tall ships set to parade in New York's harbor on Saturday.



MANSFIELD, TEXAS The Filipino American Alliance Church held a potluck while waiting for fireworks.



THIS WEEKEND **Visions of America: Everyday Founders**

MAMDANI SPEECH The mayor of New York City warned of blind patriotism. **PAGE A17**

By **MICHAEL LEVENSON**

Two hundred and fifty years after men from 13 disparate colonies made the fateful decision to adopt the Declaration of Independence, a country whose size and diversity they could have scarcely imagined will strive to set aside its divisions on Saturday and throw itself a massive sea-to-sea celebration of liberty and happiness.

Hoover, Ala., will dish up free apple pie and ice cream and try to set a Guinness record by opening the most cans of Coke simultaneously. Mount Morris, Ill., is breaking out extra bouncy houses and juicing up the finale of its annual fireworks show.

“They’re going to wake up Dixon,” said Bryon West, who is

Across Its Divides, a Country Takes Time to Celebrate Its 250th Birthday

helping with the event, referring to a city about 20 miles away.

Los Angeles and Philadelphia will throw star-studded concerts. New York City and Washington will have military jets streaking overhead and fireworks shows for the ages crackling over their skylines.

And in a backyard in Paramus, N.J., Aanand Dadawala, 50, will serve Tex-Mex food and samosas to his family before lighting off fireworks for an extra patriotic punch.

“Two-fifty is a big number, so go

big or go home,” he said.

All across the United States on Saturday, millions of Americans will take part in festivals, parades and cookouts that together form a portrait of the country in all its messy, star-spangled complexity.

The celebrations, scattered across small towns and big cities, from Presque Isle, Maine, to Chicago, to Tumwater, Wash., arrive at an uncertain moment in the nation’s long march from 1776. The Trump administration is holding onto a tenuous peace in the Middle East, with gas prices slowly

decreasing. Artificial intelligence is on the rise, potentially reshaping the economy.

Many fear that the democracy the founders envisioned may be slipping away. A recent Pew Research Center poll found that 69 percent of Americans are dissatisfied with the country’s direction, and 59 percent think the nation’s best years have passed.

Arlene Lewis of Newark was shopping for fireworks this week with her partner and daughter under a tent in a mall parking lot in Union, N.J., but said she did not feel any special excitement about the milestone holiday. She and her partner said the prices of necessities like gas and groceries were more front of mind.

Continued on Page A17

Hot? Put On a Black Caftan, Pop a Pepper and Take a Nap.

By **HIROKO TABUCHI**

Long before air-conditioning, people around the world came up with ingenious ways to beat the heat. But, really — wear dark, billowing robes? And drink tea?

The science can be surprising. As big chunks of the United States and Canada roast through the weekend, some of these ideas might be worth a closer look.

In Japan’s sweltering summer months, you might see storekeepers with a bucket of cold water, dousing hot pavement outside their stores.

The practice, called uchimizu, grew out of Japan’s tea-ceremony

The World’s Traditional Ways for Cooling Off

tradition. It was originally a purifying ritual and an act of welcome for guests. But uchimizu also has an effect on temperature thanks to what’s known as evaporative cooling — when water evaporates, it pulls heat out of the hot ground.

A 2018 study in the journal *Water* found that uchimizu caused air temperatures to drop by as much as 10 degrees Fahrenheit near the ground, even with small amounts

Continued on Page A6



Mrs. and Mr. Americana

Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce’s wedding had been shrouded in secrecy. There were signs of a starry party on Friday. **PAGE A14.**

Candidate Tests Socialist Label In Wisconsin’s Governor Race

By **KELLEN BROWNING**

Jeff Hanneman was infuriated to learn about a proposal this spring to build a 220-acre data center on the site of a shuttered paper mill near his house in Wisconsin Rapids, Wis.

Worried that the project would pollute the tranquil waters of the nearby Wisconsin River, Mr. Hanneman, 43, planted a “No Data Center” sign in his yard. And, although he’s a Republican who voted for President Trump, he decided to support a democratic socialist who has called for a pause in data center construction and is running for governor.

Democrats See Risk in Swing State Battle

“I really don’t think or care about the label,” said Mr. Hanneman, who planted a “Francesca Hong for Governor” yard sign next to the other one. “If she was voted into office, she could do a lot of good things for our state.”

The progressive movement is surging this election cycle, as liberal voters — furious with a Democratic establishment they view as old, tepid and beholden to corporate interests — are pushing for change.

Continued on Page A15

NATIONAL A12-21

A Murky Construction Spree

The cost of the president’s D.C. projects may pass \$1 billion, with taxpayers and secret donors footing the bill. **PAGE A18**

Drinking Like It’s 1776

Boston is celebrating with booze, but however tipsy tourists get, the founders probably had them beat. **PAGE A12**



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Claiming the English Flag

The St. George’s flag has been adopted by Britain’s far right. But politics-agnostic soccer fans are reclaiming it to cheer for their World Cup team. **PAGE A4**

Miraculous Venezuela Rescue

A 44-year-old security guard was pulled alive from a pancaked basement, offering a fleeting moment of hope amid a soaring death toll. **PAGE A6**

Funeral for Iran’s Slain Leader

After lying in state in Tehran, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei’s body will be taken to some of the holiest sites in Shiite Islam during a four-day procession. **PAGE A9**

BUSINESS B1-6

Financial Weirdness in U.S.A.

For all that’s good about our relationship with money, some distinctly American things are suboptimal. Please, can the 1040 fit on a postcard? **PAGE B1**

Can Money Change Iran?

U.S. officials hope prosperity’s lure will draw the nation into new policies. That approach has failed before. **PAGE B1**

TRAVEL C7-9

Revolutionary Journeys

You can follow the footsteps of some of the United States’ founders this summer in London. **PAGE C8**

ARTS C1-6

America in Video Games

Players can imagine living during the Great Depression and other stormy periods in U.S. history. **PAGE C1**

Who Needs an Art Museum?

Entertainment centers are wooing those who once might have gone to a museum to view art. **PAGE C1**



SPORTS B7-10

Tough Training at Its Peak

Many of the world’s top cyclists decamp to the mountains of southern Spain to prepare for the Tour de France. **PAGE B7**

Mexico Soccer’s Disputed Roots

Mineral del Monte, a former mining town, claims the game started there. So does nearby Pachuca. **PAGE B8**

OPINION A22-23

Robin Givhan

PAGE A22

